

Philosophers use the word 'possible' in a very broad sense: something is possible just in case it **could have happened** – no matter how absurd, or bizarre, it is.

Here are some examples of things that are possible, in this broad sense.

Leibniz thought that there must be **some** explanation of why there is a world at all because he endorsed a certain principle about explanation, known as the **principle of sufficient reason**.

possible

necessary

contingent

The sky is blue.

The sky is red.

South Quad is full of pink donkeys.

USC is a better school than Notre Dame.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

or bizare, kritis.

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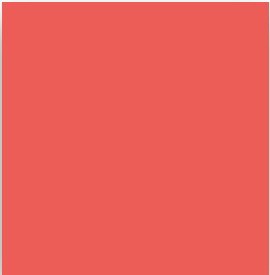
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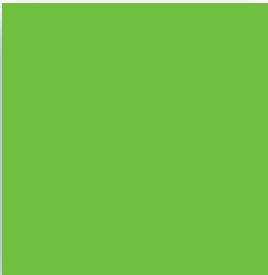
Leibniz thought that there must be **some** explanation of why there is a world at

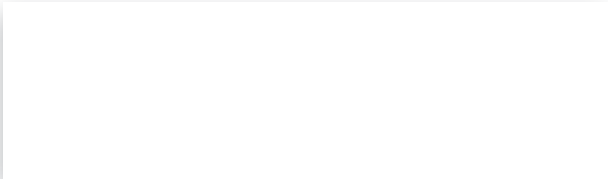
all because he understood a certain principle about explanation, known as the

principle of sufficient reason.

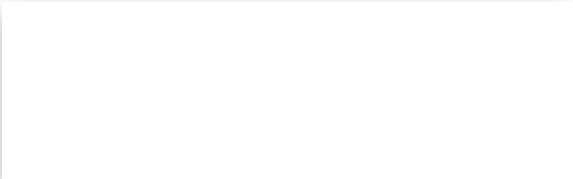




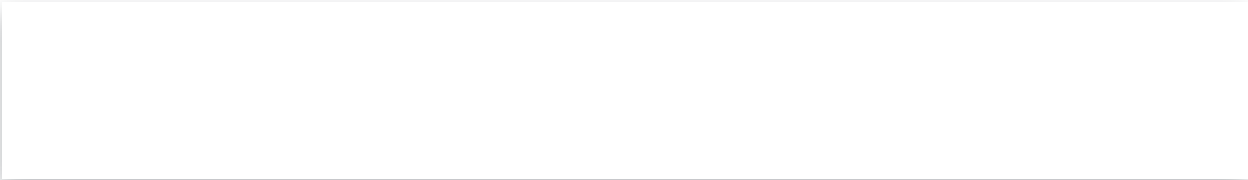




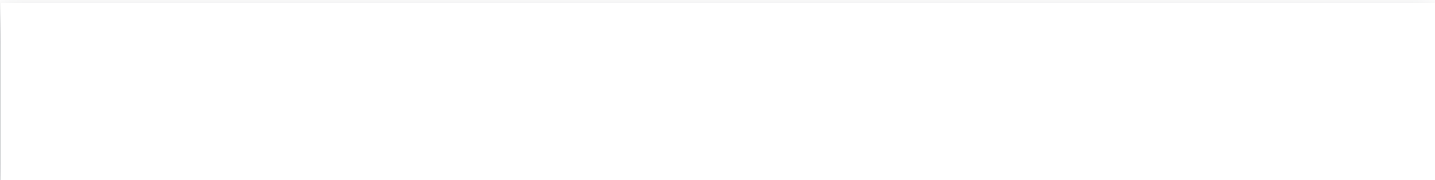
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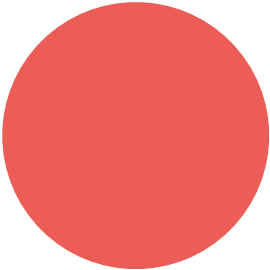
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Leibniz's
argument

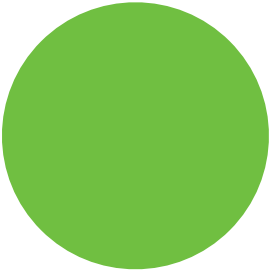






Leibniz's
argument





... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

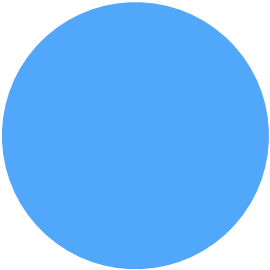
Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.





objections
to the
PSR



Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

be Good.

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to



the
PSR

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